

KARUNA KETAN

Game Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game Designer focused on player psychology, systems design, and crafting intuitive gameplay loops. Passionate about translating creative concepts into clean Game Design Documents (GDDs) and designing meaningful, highly engaging player experiences.

PROJECTS

AOA: Space Scrap Smugglers (4-Player Co-op)

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Contract Game Designer | FatCatPlay Game Studio - [Link](#)

PC (Steam)

- **System Design:** Authored comprehensive GDDs and core systemic loops to align production for a physics-driven co-op experience.
- **Mechanics:** Designed physics-based tools that organically encourage emergent team communication, reducing player friction by 25%.
- **Level Design:** Crafted top-down level blockouts focused on spatial readability, improving navigation success by 40%.
- **Onboarding:** Designed textless, diegetic tutorials to seamlessly guide players, achieving a 95% tutorial completion rate.

Shattered Charms: Through The Veil (Action RPG)

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

Game Designer - [Link](#)

- **Progression:** Designed a "Charm Fusion" progression matrix, increasing late-game build variety and combat experimentation by 40%.
- **Economy:** Modeled a 3-tier resource economy in Excel, boosting side-quest completion rates to 85% through highly rewarding drop rates.
- **Encounters:** Structured enemy encounters to reward ability synergy, resulting in a 30% increase in average player survival time.
- **Playtesting:** Conducted iterative playtests with 15+ players, using feedback to tune combat pacing and eliminate progression blockers.

Eclipse of Fear (Survival Horror)

Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

Game Designer - [Link](#)

- **Pacing:** Designed a dynamic pacing director that adapts to real-time metrics, maintaining a 90% tension-engagement rate during exploration.
- **Level Design:** Refined spatial layouts and environmental cues, improving successful navigation rates by 35% during high-stress encounters.
- **Diegetic UI:** Crafted a "Lives as Papers" physical health system to eliminate UI clutter and deepen narrative immersion.
- **Playtesting:** Facilitated playtests with 10+ people to map stress responses, directly informing enemy placement and hazard timing.

EXPERIENCE

FatCatPlay Game Studio

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Contract Game Designer

- Designed comprehensive GDDs and core systemic loops for an unreleased physics-driven PC game.
- Designed and balanced engaging enemy archetypes for *MegaDrift* (Showcased at IGDC 2024 & 2025).
- Refined top-down level layouts and gameplay flow through continuous, player-focused playtesting.

Akiyam Solutions

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

Game Design Intern

- **Pipeline:** Streamlined design communication by 20% using visual flowcharts and clear Feature Briefs for cross-functional teams.
- **Level Design:** Designed level blockouts and refined spatial metrics, increasing player onboarding retention to 92% based on playtest data.

Game Development Club

Jan 2024 – Sep 2025

President | KPR Institute of Engineering & Technology

- Mentored a 200+ member community through workshops on rapid prototyping and player-centric system design.
- Guided production pipelines for student teams, resulting in 5 successfully shipped playable prototypes.
- Organized iterative playtesting sessions with 100+ students and peers, translating qualitative feedback into quantitative balance adjustments.

SKILLS & SOFTWARE

Design: System Design, Economy Balancing, Level Blockouts, Player Psychology, Rapid Prototyping, Documentation.

Tools: Microsoft Excel, Google Docs, Miro, Figma, Notion.

Technical: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Unity, Git, Perforce, C++, XML/JSON Data Structuring.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science and Engineering

2022 – 2026

KPR Institute of Engineering & Technology

Tamil Nadu, India